

Let Me In

CONTRIBUTOR(S): ISABELLA

Challenge 243 Solves

Let Me In

5

SYNTAX **FORENSICS**

syntax



Created By: @syntax

Due to the efforts of the Turbo Tactical team, we've managed to acquire credentials belonging to **gh0st404** that can be used on a remote DEADFACE machine. Access this machine and find the flag in the user's home directory.

Submit the flag as **deadface{flag_text}**

IP Address: **hostbusters.deadface.io**
Username: **gh0st404**
Password: **ReadySetG0!**

1/100 attempts

1. I opened PuTTY in order to SSH into gh0st404's device.
2. There, I set the IP address as the target's provided IP address and loaded the SSH with only these parameters.
3. I then used the provided username and password to gain access to the gh0st404's account where I used 'ls' to see 2 available files.
 - a. notes.txt and tools.

```
env03.deadface.io - PuTTY
login as: gh0st404
gh0st404@hostbusters.deadface.io's password:
Linux env03 6.1.0-40-amd64 #1 SMP PREEMPT_DYNAMIC Debian 6.1.153-1 (2025-09-20)
x86_64

The programs included with the Debian GNU/Linux system are free software;
the exact distribution terms for each program are described in the
individual files in /usr/share/doc/*/copyright.

Debian GNU/Linux comes with ABSOLUTELY NO WARRANTY, to the extent
permitted by applicable law.
Last login: Sat Oct 25 19:22:11 2025 from 77.238.248.12
ls
~ $ ls
notes.txt  tools
~ $
```

4. I chose to open the notes.txt file, where I found the flag at the bottom highlighted in yellow.

```
Day 1 ... 10:56 PM
Started poking... around De Monne...s public face. Clean enough on the outside, but you know how it goes ... pretty lobby, rotten basement. Grabbed some domains: demonnefinancial.com, plus a couple cute little subdomains hangin... off it.

Day 2 ... 01:12 AM
Email patterns? Easy. first.last@demonnefinancial.com. Classic rookie move. Ran a quick scrape off LinkedIn ... already got a list of 50+ employees. Shoutout to the interns who think posting their whole r..sum.. online is a flex.

Day 3 ... 02:20 AM
Spotted their VPN login page. Looks shiny, probably thinks it...s bulletproof. No MFA prompt though. That...s a red flag. If it...s really missing, well... let...s just say some middle manager is definitely rookin... ..Password123!... s

Day 4 ... 11:37 PM
Their external web app? Yikes. Old Apache headers, outdated PHP version just sittin... there. Might as well hang a ...hack me... sign on the door. Gonna run some deeper scans later. Bet I...ll find something dusty.

Day 5 ... 03:03 AM
Poked at their DNS records tonight. Found a staging server hanging out in the wild. Who does that in 2025? Might just be a breadcrumb, but if it...s real... it...s prob got hardcoded creds all over it. Note to self: come back when I...M

Day 6 ... 12:18 AM
Weird thing: their main site pushes traffic through Cloudflare, but half their subdomains don...t. Split-brain security. Classic. Whoever set this up either out corners or didn...t know what the hell they were doing. Both work in my favo

Day 7 ... 01:45 AM
No break-ins yet ... just circling the building, peeking in the windows. Feels like De Monne wants me to think they...re solid. But I can see the cracks. Just need the right pressure to make ...em split.

deadface(hostbusters1_cf6a12ddf781efbc)
```

Flag: **deadface(hostbusters1_cf6a12ddf781efbc)**